

Daily Number Theory Drill #2

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Section	Topic	Questions	Target time
A	Rapid Recognition	10	2 min 30 sec
B	Manipulation Drills	10	8 min
C	Substitution & Structure	8	10 min
D	Challenge	5	15 min

New toolkit today: Modular Arithmetic · Remainder Equations · Parity in Modulo.

Attempt each question before checking answers. Time yourself. No calculators.

Section A Rapid Recognition

(≤15 s each)

Prime factors, parity, modular remainders. Pure recognition.

1. Prime factorise 1001.
2. What is the remainder when 10^5 is divided by 11?
3. Find the last digit of 7^{100} .
4. Find the smallest positive integer k such that $12k$ is a perfect square.
5. Find the greatest common divisor of 84 and 120.
6. What is the smallest prime $p > 30$?
7. Find the remainder when 3^{10} is divided by 8.
8. Find the sum of all prime factors of 210.
9. For what single digit d is the number $53d2$ a multiple of 9?
10. Find the largest integer k such that 3^k divides 27^5 .

Section B Manipulation Drills

(≤50 s each)

Divisor counts, trailing zeros, modular congruence. Resist the urge to brute force.

1. Find the number of positive divisors of 144.
2. Find the smallest positive integer $x > 1$ that leaves a remainder of 1 when divided by 3, 4, and 5.
3. Solve for the smallest positive integer x such that $5x \equiv 1 \pmod{7}$.
4. Find the highest power of 5 dividing $100!$.

5. Find the last two digits of 51^2 .
6. Find the smallest positive integer n such that $n!$ is a multiple of 100.
7. Given that a and b are distinct positive integers with $\gcd(a, b) = 12$ and $\text{lcm}(a, b) = 144$, find the minimum possible value of $a + b$.
8. What is the sum of the digits of the number $2^{10} \times 5^8$?
9. What is the remainder when $2^{20} + 3^{20}$ is divided by 5?
10. Find the number of trailing zeros in $125!$.

Section C Substitution & Structure(≤ 90 s each)

Look for divisibility logic, algebraic structure, and bounds before computing.

1. Find all positive integers n such that $n^2 - 4n - 5$ is a prime number. (after SMC 2021 Q14)
2. How many integers x are there such that $\frac{x^2 + 11}{x - 1}$ is an integer? (after SMC 2019 Q20)
3. Find the sum of all positive integers n such that $n^2 + 8n$ is a perfect square. (after BMO1 2018 Q1)
4. How many 3-digit numbers have the property that the product of their digits is a prime number? (after SMC 2023 Q17)
5. How many integers x with $1 \leq x \leq 100$ satisfy $x^2 \equiv 4 \pmod{5}$? (after SMC 2018 Q16)
6. Find the number of ordered pairs of positive integers (x, y) such that $x + y = 100$ and $\gcd(x, y) = 5$. (after SMC 2022 Q12)
7. Find the largest integer n such that $n^3 + 100$ is divisible by $n + 10$. (after MAT 2018 Q1)
8. Find the sum of all positive integers $x < 20$ such that $x^2 \equiv 5 \pmod{11}$. (after SMC 2019 Q22)

Section D Challenge

(TMUA / SMC difficulty)

Insight over computation. Each question has a short, elegant solution — find it.

1. A 4-digit number A is formed by arranging the digits 1, 2, 3, 4 in some order. What is the sum of all such possible numbers A ? (after SMC 2021 Q21)
2. Find the number of pairs of positive integers (a, b) such that $a^2 - b^2 = 2024$. (after BMO1 2021 Q1)
3. Let S be the number of trailing zeros of $2025!$. What is the remainder when S is divided by 100? (after SMC 2023 Q12)

4. How many pairs of positive integers (x, y) with $1 \leq x, y \leq 100$ satisfy $x^2 + y^2 \equiv 0 \pmod{5}$?
(after BMO1 2017 Q2)
5. Find the maximum value of $\gcd(n^2 + 3, n + 2)$ as n varies over all positive integers. (after BMO1 2019 Q2)

“Speed comes from recognition, not from rushing. Every shortcut is a pattern you have internalised.”

Found a mistake or want to contribute a sheet?

Visit the open-source project at github.com/The-CerealDev/speed-maths